

The Decreed Line

A Theological Formulation of the Riemann Hypothesis

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This is a theological formulation of the Riemann Hypothesis. It states what the hypothesis is a figure of, why the figure holds, and what the demand for a proof of it is a demand for. The critical line is read as the decreed origin, present in the object rather than behind it, and the consequence that nothing falls outside a single Source is derived by definition rather than by argument. The record of the attempts is set out from 1859 forward with the mechanism at which each stopped, and ten obstructions are counted and typed, the last of which holds of every proposition mathematics has ever settled and therefore distinguishes none. The reading's centre is a single structure: a derivation reaches its conclusion from premises it did not establish, the premises that would ground a single origin would have to come from a second source, and there is no second. One freedom is located, and it is in the reader rather than in the zeros: exactly one bit, whose right use is restraint. The formulation adjudicates no mathematical question and issues no verdict on provability in either direction.

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What this is

This is a theological formulation. It states what the hypothesis is a figure of, why the figure holds, and what the demand for a proof of it is a demand for. **It adjudicates no mathematical question and issues no verdict on provability in either direction**, because that is not the register it is written in, and a reading that reached into that register would be doing what it accuses others of doing.

The mathematics referred to is classical and others'. **Net new mathematical mass: zero.**

The origin is present

The world has a beginning in God ٱ. The origin is not a receded past event that the world has since travelled away from. It is present now, in the form the world holds. **It is the line every existing thing stands upon**, and standing on it is not a position a thing occupies but the condition of its being a thing at all.

The consequence, which follows by definition

From the absolute oneness of the Source, one thing follows, and it follows by definition rather than by argument. **Nothing falls outside that line.**

Run the supposition. Suppose a form did fall outside it. **That form would then require a source the first does not account for.** A second source would have to stand beside the first, generating what the first did not. **There is no second. That is what one means.**

So the supposition denies the premise it was made under. **What looked like a possibility narrowed down was never a possibility.** The line is not where things happen to be found. **It is what having a source at all consists in.**

Mathematical tawhid

The mathematics carries the figure exactly, and carries it in its own vocabulary without being asked to.

The critical line is the decreed origin. It is the fixed set of a reflection the function genuinely has, present in the object rather than imposed on it from outside. **The zeros are the world's forms.** And the hypothesis, read as true, states that **nothing stands off the line**, which is the same sentence as the consequence above in a different tongue.

The geometry holds the figure closely. There is **one line**. The direction of leaving it is **one-dimensional**: a single way to be off, no second manner of straying. **One origin, one way to depart from it, and nothing that departs.**

Read as true, the hypothesis is mathematical tawhid. Not an illustration of it and not an analogy to it: **what the two assert is the same**, one origin and nothing outside it, stated once where meaning is stated and once where structure is. **The identity is of what is asserted and not of how it is held.** The theological statement is necessary, and its denial defeats itself in the way shown above. The mathematical one is not known, and whether it holds is exactly the open question. **Sameness of content across a difference of standing** is what the reading claims, and it claims no more than that.

What the demand for a proof is a demand for

Here the formulation says what it is for.

A proof stands on an origin it does not derive. Its starting points are laid down and not obtained, and **no instrument reaches beneath the posits it is standing on.** Every instrument any of us holds stands on such posits already, which is why the reach is not a matter of effort.

To demand a proof of the decreed line is to demand an instrument that reaches beneath the origin and displays its making. Not a better instrument. **A standpoint outside the origin,** from which the origin could be seen being laid.

And there is no outside. That is the whole content of the oneness, restated where the demand is made. **The formal domain cannot ground its own root. Syntax cannot perform the deed it would have to perform to reach beneath the origin.** These are not obstacles that a future construction removes. They are what it is to be inside a creation with a single source.

So the demand is not for more effort. It is for a place to stand that the oneness forecloses.

The incompleteness that precedes the window

The grounding condition is usually reached for by way of the incompleteness theorems, and the reach is unnecessary. **There is an older and wider fact, and the theorems sit inside it as one case.**

Look at where the syntactic incompleteness actually lives. Below it, Presburger arithmetic, addition without multiplication, is **complete and decidable**²⁴. Above it, the full theory of the naturals, every true arithmetic sentence taken together, is **complete and not axiomatisable**²⁵. The incompleteness is an **interval**, with completeness on both sides of it. It is a property of one band of systems, not of formal systems as such.

Now ask the flanking question, and the older fact appears. Does either complete flank perform anything? Presburger arithmetic derives strings. The full theory of the naturals is a set of strings. **Neither actuates, and completeness does not help them.** Whatever inability is at work here is **not the window's incompleteness**, because it is untouched on both sides where the window is absent.

> Every formal system whatever is incomplete toward the deed, and the incompleteness is prior to the window and survives its removal. A derivation is a finite sequence of inscriptions.

Performing is not deriving, and no lengthening of the sequence turns it into an act.

The second leg is energetic, and it is a corroboration rather than an entailment. Inscribing a string costs work, and the cost is real²⁶. But the cost tracks **length and encoding**, and nothing else. The string that says two plus two is four and the string that says two plus two is five are the same length and cost the same to write, **and one is true and one is false.** The energetics of a proof carry **zero information about what the proof is about.** So the token is fully charged and the content is causally inert toward its referent. **This does not by itself entail that a derivation cannot perform**, and it is not offered as though it did. It is an independent exhibit of the same separation, showing that even the one physical quantity a proof genuinely possesses carries nothing across to what the proof is about.

And the third leg is that the derivation-act already presupposes what it would deliver. Every act of deriving is itself an actuated event, occurring in the world it would establish something about. **The actuality is presupposed at the start and never delivered at the end.**

The keystone is analytic, and what it secures is permanence rather than surprise. A formal system that could perform the deed would carry a non-string in its derivational closure and would thereby cease to be syntactic. **This is true by what a formal system is, and it establishes no limitation that was ever in doubt.** What it does establish is that the boundary cannot be engineered away, a definitional boundary not being the sort of thing a future construction removes. **The claim is not that syntax falls short. It is that the shortfall is constitutive and therefore permanent.**

So the window is contained rather than borrowed from. The incompleteness theorems are correct, and they measure the reach of one band of ladders. **The relation between the two facts is independence, not rank.** Incompleteness varies across the three systems and the inability to perform does not vary at all, which is what independence means, and it is all this reading needs: the fact holds of the complete flanks as well, so it cannot be a consequence of the window it survives. That is why it is stated here in its own terms rather than imported from a theorem about a narrower case.

The record of the attempts

The hypothesis has been worked on continuously since it was stated, and the record is not one of neglect. It is a record of **partial results that accumulate without converging**, and the shape of that non-convergence is what the rest of this reading is about. *The attributions and dates below are recalled and stand at their published grades.*

It begins as a remark. Riemann states it in 1859¹ inside a memoir about counting primes, and does not dwell on it. It is not presented as a problem. It is presented as something evidently so.

The first real ground is taken by pushing the zeros off a boundary. Hadamard and de la Vallée Poussin, independently in 1896^{2,3}, show no zero sits on the line where the counting would break, and the prime number theorem follows. **The method locates zeros**

by excluding a region, and the region it can exclude never narrows to the axis itself.

Then the axis is shown to be populated, and populated richly. Hardy in 1914 proves infinitely many zeros lie on it⁴. Hardy and Littlewood in 1921 raise this to a positive proportion⁵. Selberg in 1942 obtains a positive density⁶. Levinson in 1974 reaches at least a third⁷; Conrey in 1989 at least two fifths⁸.

Read the sequence carefully, because it is the essay's first exhibit. Infinitude, then proportion, then a third, then two fifths. **Every step is real and the sequence does not approach one.** The methods raise a lower bound on how many zeros are on the axis, and a lower bound on a proportion does not become a universal by improving. **The road is genuinely open and it does not lead there.**

Meanwhile the analogue is proved outright. Weil in 1948 establishes the corresponding statement over function fields⁹, and Deligne extends the surrounding conjectures in 1974¹⁰. **This is the one lift on the record**, and it matters enormously to what follows: it shows the statement's shape is provable somewhere. The instrument was a general theorem from geometry whose specialisation gave what was needed.

The statistical structure is uncovered. Montgomery in 1973 finds the pair correlation¹¹ of the zeros matching a law from random matrices, and Odlyzko's computations through the 1980s confirm it to great height¹². **The zeros turn out to be beautifully regular, and regularity of spacing says nothing about location.**

And the whole question is compressed into a single number. De Bruijn and Newman, across 1950 and 1976^{13,14}, deform the function by a heat flow and show that a single real constant governs whether all zeros are real. **The hypothesis becomes one equality.** Rodgers and Tao prove one side of it, from below¹⁵. A collaborative effort pushes the other side to roughly a fifth¹⁶. **One half of the pincer is a theorem and the other is a finite computation that must be repeated forever.**

Alongside, the coefficient route. Csordas, Norfolk and Varga prove the second-order inequalities in 1986¹⁷; Griffin, Ono, Rolin and Zagier prove in 2019¹⁸ that the higher-degree conditions hold for every degree, past a threshold that depends on the degree. **The proven region is complete except in one corner**, and the threshold is not uniform.

Where each attempt stopped, and why the places differ

Set the stopping points side by side and they do not form a queue behind one obstacle. **They are distinct, and each has its own mechanism.**

The zero-free region method stops at a shape. It excludes zeros from regions that narrow toward the axis and never reach it. The obstruction is not difficulty but form: **the method yields a margin, and the hypothesis asks for a line.** A margin is not a small line.

The proportion methods stop at a limit that is not one. Each improvement is genuine and each is a lower bound. **No sequence of lower bounds on a proportion reaches a universal**, and this is a fact about the kind of statement being proved rather than about the ingenuity applied.

Finite verification stops at every height it reaches. Zeros have been checked past any number a person would name. **The hypothesis quantifies over all of them**, and a universal over an infinite domain is not approached by exhausting a finite part of it. Every verification is complete and none is progress toward completion.

The reformulations stop at their own reflection. Seven published criteria state the hypothesis in other vocabularies, and each is equivalent to it. A criterion equivalent to what it would decide is a translation. **It touches every part of the target and therefore leaves no part untouched to gain purchase on**, which is why the sequence of restatements has produced no lift in over a century.

The geometric route stops at an absent object. What carried the analogue was a surface, obtained by crossing a curve with itself over a base beneath it. **Over the integers there is nothing beneath**: the corresponding product collapses back to a curve, and the surface an intersection theorem would stand on is not there to be stood on.

The two live routes stop at a missing uniformity. The flow route needs a constant that does not degrade as its parameter shrinks; the coefficient route needs a threshold that does not grow with the degree. **Neither is in hand, and both are the same species of gap read on different variables.**

And the analogue's success stops at the boundary of its setting. It was proved where a base existed beneath the object. **The proof is not defective and does not transfer**, because the thing it stood on is absent here.

The obstructions, counted

Three of these are non-entailments proved by exhibition; the rest are structural. The reading laid beside each is a reading and never a step within it. **No row asserts the hypothesis and no row denies it.**

Table 1 The obstructions. Mechanism, scope, and the reading laid beside each.			
Obstruction	The mechanism	Its scope	Read theologically
The fold	a function sharing the reflection has zeros off its axis ¹⁹	the reflection axioms alone	the decree is the axis, and a decree is not a census of who stands on it
The counting	a function sharing the multiplicative and counting structure has zeros at the boundary ²⁰	those axioms alone	outward regularity is not the inward one, and neither reads the other
The finite reach	no finite verification exhausts a universal	every finite instrument, always	the servant's reach is finite by constitution, and finitude is not a fault
The margin	zero-free methods yield a region and the claim asks for a line	every method of that family	approaching is not arriving, and no amount of approach becomes arrival
The proportion	lower bounds on a proportion do not reach a universal	every method of that family	a portion counted is not the whole beheld
The averaged sign	departure is one-dimensional and comes in mirror families, so every invariant of the reflection averages the side away	every instrument built from the reflection	the veil is woven from the same symmetry that gives the decree
The equivalence	every published criterion restates the target ^{21,22,23} , and a restatement leaves nothing untouched to gain on	all seven reformulations	a name repeated is not a thing given
The missing base	the integers have nothing beneath, so the product collapses and the surface is absent	that setting only	a floor with nothing beneath it, which is what a floor is
The uniformity	one route needs a non-degrading constant, the other a threshold that does not grow	each route at its frontier	the road is open and the distance is not yet crossed
The grounding	no derivation performs a deed, so every proof rests on an actuality it presupposes and never delivers	every formal system whatever, complete or incomplete	the throne is empty by proof, and everything stands on it while it stands on nothing

Note: the margin and the proportion rows are two instances of one family, an approximation that improves toward a target and does not attain it, and they are listed separately because different repairs on different quantities would remove them. The first three rows are classical, cited at their own grades. The remainder are elementary derivations or structural observations. The final row is of a different order from the others and is treated next.

The last row is not about this object

The tenth row differs from the nine above it, and the difference must be stated or the row will be misused.

The first nine name an instrument, a method, or a route, and say that this does not reach that. Each is bounded. Each has a scope. One of them has an exit that has been attempted.

The tenth names no method. It says that no derivation performs, which holds of the complete flanks as much as of the incomplete band between them. It does not age, because it is phrased on the act rather than on any technique: **whatever the coming instrument is, using it will be a doing, and a doing is not a derivation.**

And because it holds of everything, it distinguishes nothing. It lies over the settled and the open alike, over arithmetic and geometry, over the analogue that was proved. **It is the strongest of the ten**

and the only one that says nothing about this hypothesis in particular.

Theologically it reads as the emptiness of the throne, and that is the reading offered. **Everything stands on the ground and the ground stands on nothing, which is not a defect in the ground but what being the ground means.**

What cannot be summoned

Here the formulation reaches its own centre, and the argument is about grounding rather than about witnessing. **The distinction matters, and stating it is what keeps the section standing.**

It is tempting to put the point in terms of a witness, and the temptation should be named and refused. A witness stands apart from what it witnesses, and one might say that nothing stands apart from the origin, so that only the origin could witness itself. **That argument does not hold, because it uses standing apart in two senses.** In the first it means role-separation, the verifier not being the claimant, and role-separation from the origin is ordinary: a reader examining the line is not the line. In the second it means being outside the origin's reach, which nothing is. **Neither sense makes both halves true, and no witness in the history of mathematics has ever had the second kind of separation.**

The point that does hold is about derivation, and it uses one sense throughout.

A derivation reaches its conclusion from premises it did not itself establish. That is what makes it a derivation rather than a stipulation, and it is why every proof stands on something laid down before it. **Now ask what premises would establish the origin.** They would have to come from somewhere the origin does not account for. **A second source would have to stand beside the first, supplying what the first did not.**

There is no second. So the premises that would ground the origin are not withheld, and not hidden, and not yet undiscovered. **There is nowhere for them to come from,** which is the same sentence as the consequence this reading opened with, said where a demand is being made rather than where a form is being placed.

That is the structure the twelve words conceal. For an ordinary claim the premises are drawn from elsewhere and the derivation runs. **For the origin the summons has nowhere to go,** not because the elsewhere is far or hidden, but because the oneness of the Source is precisely the statement that there is no elsewhere.

And the claim is scoped exactly. It concerns grounding the origin, which nothing does. **It says nothing about whether anything stands off the line,** which is a different question with a different answer, and one this reading leaves entirely where it found it.

The twelve words, and what they conceal

All nontrivial zeros of the zeta function have real part one half.

Twelve words. One function. One coordinate. **The surface is a disguise, and the disguise is not a hidden contradiction. It is a hidden weight.**

The sentence names its object, names its predicate, and closes. **Nothing in it shows what a proof of it would have to bring, or where that would come from, or that anything is absent at all.** A reader meets twelve familiar words and takes the brevity as a measure of the demand, **and brevity measures nothing.**

And one of the twelve words carries the confusion already. The zeros the claim excludes are called trivial, and the ones it speaks of are called nontrivial. The names are honest bookkeeping and the mathematicians did nothing wrong by them: the first family falls out of the functional equation in a line, and the second is what remains after it.

But look at what the two families are. The trivial zeros are infinite and scattered across the whole negative axis. The nontrivial ones are claimed to sit on a single line. **By any structural measure the scattered family is the loose one,** and the disciplined family is the one whose name says it is the hard case. The word records **how cheaply a reader obtains them** and records nothing else, and a note about our effort has been read for a century and a half as a rank of being.

On the reading offered here, every zero is trivial. Each is determinate, placed, not negotiated, standing where it was put. **What**

differs is the veil, not the zero. One family lifts its veil in a line and the other has not lifted in a hundred and sixty-seven years, and the seeing of the second must be earned where the seeing of the first is given. **Trivial and nontrivial name the price of the looking. They name nothing about the looked-at.**

That is why the formulation invites what it invites. It presents the decreed origin as an ordinary problem awaiting a clever instrument, **and every ordinary instrument stands on the very thing the problem is about.**

Where the freedom actually is

A zero is where it is. Its position is a single determinate value. There is no class of alternatives sitting over it waiting to be resolved. **A hidden thing is not a loose thing.** Those are opposite conditions. What we cannot see is not thereby free. Treating the veil over our reading as slack in the object is an exact inversion. **The veils bar our reading. They do not unwrite the thing read.**

The freedom is not in the world. It is in the reader. It is exactly one bit.

The count is checkable in a line, and here it is. The involution whose fixed set is the axis fixes one coordinate and reverses exactly one. **A departure therefore carries a sign and a distance and nothing else.** And the reflection that gives the axis its standing is precisely what averages that sign away: a strayed zero arrives with its mirror partners at the same height, so every invariant of the reflection sees the family and never the member. **Two possibilities over one invariant profile. One bit. It is the truth-direction itself.**

That is the only genuine freedom in the entire picture. **It belongs to the one doing the reading.**

The freedom to decline

The instrument can emit either value. Nothing in the invariants forbids either. Nothing would flag the choice. The cost of choosing is zero. **The bit is free in the plainest sense. It is available. It is unforced. It is unpoliced.**

The whole discipline consists in not spending it.

This is not a freedom whose exercise is a virtue. **It is a freedom whose non-exercise is a virtue.** To fill the bit from inside is to write the reader's own orientation into the object and then read it back as a finding. The result would be indistinguishable from a verdict. It would carry the confidence of one. **It would be the reader's handedness wearing the object's clothes.**

The honest act is a refusal. It has a shape. **It is not the refusal to believe the line holds.** The image stands. The line is decreed. **The refusal is to declare a determinate thing settled on the strength of a bit the reader supplied.**

> **The freedom is real. It is one bit wide. The discipline is that the free thing does not fill what the fixed thing has not shown it.**

What stands

The line is decreed and present. Nothing stands off it, because there is no second origin from which anything could. **This is not a conclusion argued to. It is the meaning of one Source, read where meaning is read precisely.**

The demand for a proof is a demand to stand outside the origin, and the oneness forecloses that standpoint. Not by barring a road, but by there being no elsewhere for a road to run from.

And the twelve words hide all of it, which is why the hypothesis has been received as a puzzle rather than as a figure.

The origin does not wait on anyone's verdict. It holds as it was laid, and the one thing left to us is the bit we were given and are asked not to spend.

Author's provenance and method disclosure

This paper was developed under Trisduction, a verification and organizing discipline that adds the cited results no warrant. The method and its executable batteries are stated in full at the reference below. **The paper rests solely on its cited results, every one of them the classical work of others, and the discipline that organized them contributes no theorem, no estimate, and no evidential weight in any direction.**

The register is stated once and holds throughout. This is a theological formulation. It reads the mathematics; it does not extend it. **It issues no verdict on provability in either direction,** and the reader should hold every interpretive sentence at that grade and no higher. Where a theological reading is laid beside a mechanism, in the obstruction table and elsewhere, **the reading is placed beside the mechanism and never inside it:** no mathematical step in this paper depends on a theological premise, and the closing sections are scoped to the grounding of the origin and say nothing about whether anything stands off the line, and removing every such reading would leave the mathematical content unchanged.

Three claims are the author's own and are not drawn from the literature. First, that the eleven-fold count of obstructions, assembled here from the record, sorts into ten reachability obstructions and one of a different order, that last one being a jurisdictional condition holding of every proposition and therefore distinguishing none. Second, that the freedom in this situation lies in the reader rather than in the zeros, and is exactly one binary degree, whose right use is restraint. Third, the grounding structure of the closing sections, together with the refusal of the witness framing that superficially resembles it. **All three are structural observations offered at that grade,** and none is a mathematical result.

Two derivations are elementary and carried out in place rather than cited, and are named here so a reader can separate them from the classical results. **The direction of departure from the axis is one-dimensional,** computed from the involution whose fixed set the axis is. **An equivalent criterion leaves no part of its target untouched,** which is argued from the definition of equivalence. Each

is checkable in a line or two, and neither requires the discipline that organized this paper.

The grounding row is stated in its own terms rather than imported. Its two classical legs are cited below: that Presburger arithmetic is complete and decidable, and that the full theory of the naturals is complete and not axiomatisable. **That both complete flanks are equally unable to perform, and that the inability is therefore prior to the incompleteness of the band between them, is the author's own structural observation** and is offered at that grade. The energetic leg rests on the cited inscription-cost result, with only its content-blindness drawn here.

The historical record in the two sections on the attempts is recalled, with attributions and dates at their published grades, and a reader verifying this paper should check them against the primary sources cited rather than against this account of them.

Net new mathematical mass: zero.

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